



Presented by The High End



CARDBOARD WINGS

Wearable 5-Piece Wing Set — Strutted, Strapped & Paintable

One blueprint, three costumes — paint them feathered, leathery or scaled.

AGES
4–12

BOXES
2 Medium Boxes

TIME
45–90 Minutes

DIFF
Beginner *

PIECES
5 pcs

CARDBOARD NEEDED:

2 Medium Boxes (at least 18" × 24" (46 × 61 cm) each)

MISSION GOAL:

Build and wear a 5-piece wing set: 2 strutted wing panels on a shared back plate, held with crossed shoulder straps.

A

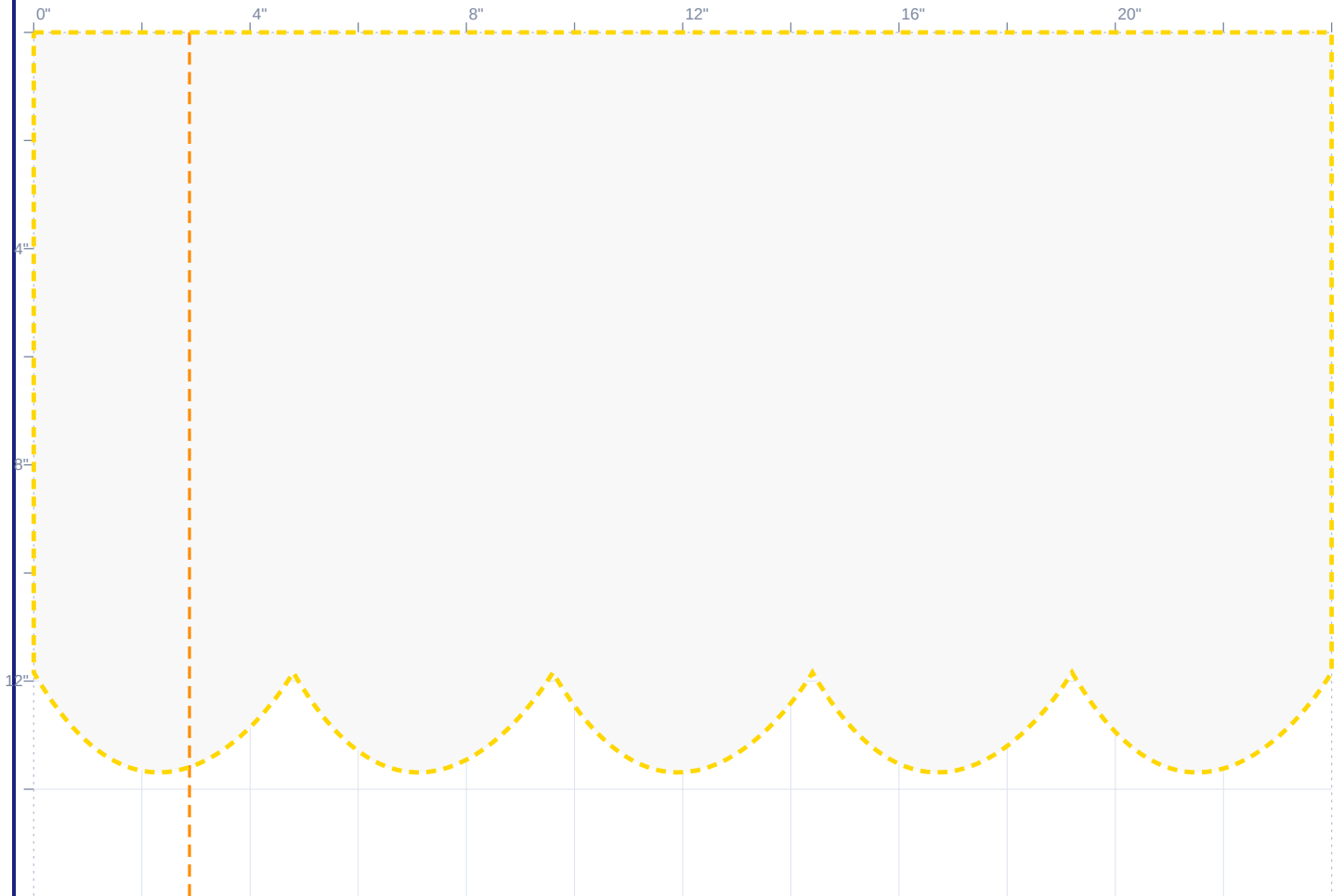
WING PANEL

24" × 16" (61 × 41 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

WING PANEL

x2

**HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:**

Divide the outer edge into 5 equal sections of about 4.8". In each one, trace round a mug to scoop out a curve 4.2" deep.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

24" × 16" (61 × 41 cm)

Scalloped outer edge — curved scoops

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Scallop the long outer edge



WING STRUT

22" × 4" (56 × 10 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

WING STRUT

x2

0"4"8"12"16"20"

FOLD LENGTHWAYS into an L — the fold is the strength

22" × 4" (56 × 10 cm)
THIS is what stops wings flopping

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

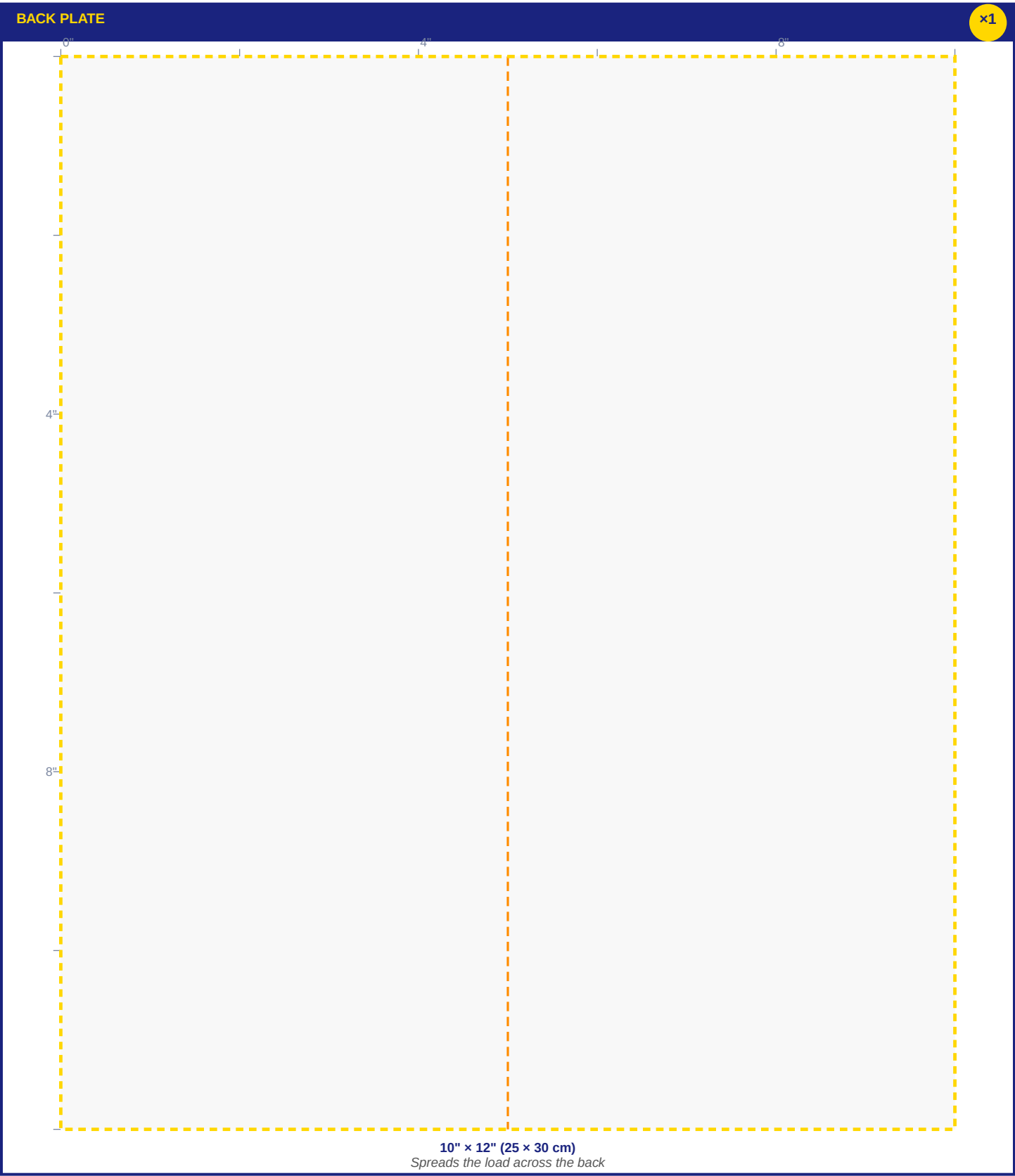
NOTE: THIS is what stops wings flopping



BACK PLATE

10" × 12" (25 × 30 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Spreads the load across the back



SHOULDER STRAP

20" x 3" (51 x 8 cm) | Cut x2

CUT
x2

SHOULDER STRAP

0"4"8"12"16"

FOLD TAB — tapes to the Back Plate

FOLD TAB — tapes to the Back Plate

20" x 3" (51 x 8 cm)
Over the shoulders, crossed at the back

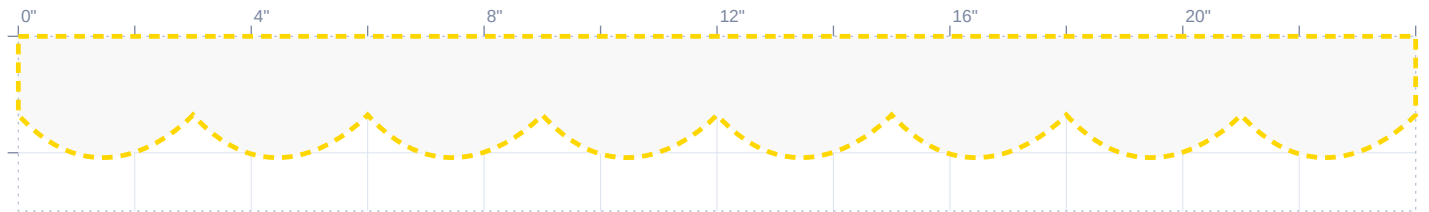
MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Over the shoulders, crossed at the back

SCALLOP STRIP

x2

**HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:**

Divide the strip into 8 equal sections of about 3" and trace a cup bottom in each to make the scoops.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

24" × 3" (61 × 8 cm)

Scallop strip — repeating scoops

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: Optional second layer for depth

WHAT YOU NEED — CARDBOARD WINGS

CARDBOARD PIECES — 5 TOTAL (2 Medium Boxes (at least 18" × 24" (46 × 61 cm) each))

×2 **Wing Panel**
24" × 16"

Scallop the long outer edge

×2 **Wing Strut**
22" × 4"

THIS is what stops wings flopping

×1 **Back Plate**
10" × 12"

Spreads the load across the back

×2 **Shoulder Strap**
20" × 3"

Over the shoulders, crossed at the back

×2 **Scallop Strip**
24" × 3"

Optional second layer for depth

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

+ 2 medium cardboard boxes

+ Scissors

+ Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY

+ Packing tape

+ Ruler + pencil

+ Paint or markers — feathers, leather or scales, your choice

+ Ribbon or elastic for the straps (optional, comfier)

FUN FACT!

A wandering albatross has a wingspan of about 11 feet — wider than most cars are long.

CHALLENGE!

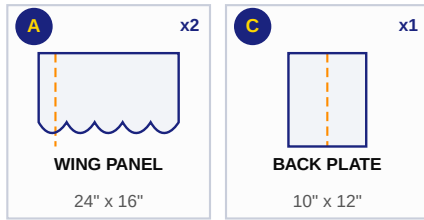
Paint challenge: feathers make an owl or an angel, smooth panels make a bat, overlapping scallops make a dragon. Same wings, three creatures.

1

STEP 1: FLATTEN & MEASURE

Flatten both boxes. Measure the child from shoulder to shoulder — that width is where the Back Plate sits. Lay both Wing Panels out as a mirrored pair before cutting.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



2

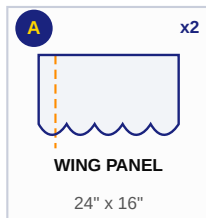
STEP 2: CUT THE WING PANELS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Cut 2 Wing Panels (24" x 16" (61 x 41 cm)). Cut the scalloped curve along the long outer edge of each — follow the cut line on the template. Stack both and compare: they must mirror each other, not match.

SAFETY: Adult uses the box cutter. Kids trace the scallop line in pencil first.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

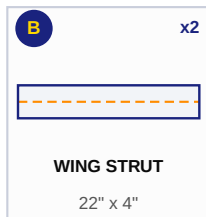


3

STEP 3: FOLD THE STRUTS

Fold each Wing Strut lengthways down the middle into an L shape. This is the most important step in the build — a flat strip does nothing, a folded L is stiff. Press the fold hard along its whole length.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



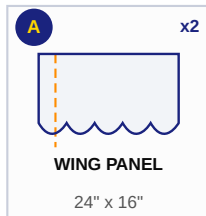
4

STEP 4: MOUNT THE STRUTS

Tape one folded Strut along the leading edge of each Wing Panel, on the marked fold line, L opening backward. Tape every 3 inches. Now lift the wing by the strut — it should hold its shape and barely bend.

SAFETY: If the wing still droops, add a second strip of tape the full length. Do not skip this — a drooping wing is the one thing that makes these look homemade.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



5

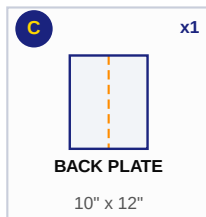
STEP 5: BUILD THE BACK PLATE

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Cut the Back Plate (10" × 12" (25 × 30 cm)). Tape the inner end of each wing to it, one either side of the centre line, angled slightly upward and back. The plate carries the weight so the child's shoulders do not.

SAFETY: Two people helps here — one holds the wings at the angle, one tapes.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



6

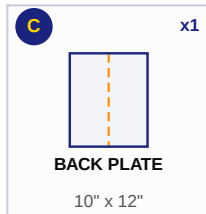
STEP 6: FIT THE STRAPS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Fold the tabs on both Shoulder Straps. Tape them to the top of the Back Plate, run them over the shoulders, cross them at the chest and tape to the bottom of the plate. Over the shoulders and across the chest — never around the neck.

SAFETY: Straps go over the shoulders only. Never a neck loop.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



7

STEP 7: PAINT & QUALITY CHECK

Paint the wings, then layer the Scallop Strips over the edges if you want extra depth. Final test: child wears them, walks through a doorway and turns around. Wings stay up, straps comfortable, nothing catches. That is the standard.

SAFETY: Wings are wider than the child. Practise doorways and stairs before going out, and add reflective tape for after dark.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



QUALITY CHECK!

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations